We know that the trigger for kick-starting Datta Khel was the accession of Jammu and Kashmir to India, by virtue of the state signing the Instrument of Accession. We also know that the installation of Sir George Cunningham as the Governor of NWFP was integral for both the aforementioned operations to be carried out. We also know that the mobilisation of tribesmen for the invasion, by using the cutouts of Khan Abdul Qayyum Khan and the Pir of Manki Sharif, could not have happened until Abdul Qayyum Khan became the Chief Minister of NWFP on 23 August 1947. Only after 23 August 1947 and after receiving Sir George Cunningham's blessing, could Abdul Qayyum Khan and the Pir of Manki Sharif start mobilising the tribal *lashkars*. This process would definitely take at least three to four weeks.

Treachery in NWFP

Most historians are unaware that Sir George Cunningham had been cleverly planning for the Partition and the transfer of power since 1944. In 1944, blessed by Cunningham, who was then serving his second term as the Governor of NWFP, a frontier committee was formed under Lt. Gen. Sir Francis Tucker and its task was to recommend a new frontier policy. This committee recommended that regular Indian Army troops should be withdrawn from the Razmak, Wana and Khyber Pass garrisons and be replaced with scouts and *khassadars* (tribal levies).[5] Sir George Cunningham and Sir Olaf Caroe both recommended immediate implementation of these recommendations. The immediate effect of this was to remove all Hindu and Sikh army officers and soldiers from the NWFP and have the northern frontiers of India only defended by the Muslim staffed-Frontier Scouts and Frontier Constabulary.

In 1944, the Indian Army's Khojak Brigade on the Baluchistan frontier was disbanded. In March 1945, the Indian Army's Tal Brigade was disbanded and some of its units were assigned to the Kohat Brigade. In April 1946, Indian Army Commander-in-Chief, Field Marshal Sir Claude Auchinleck, presided over a high-level conference at Peshawar. It was